

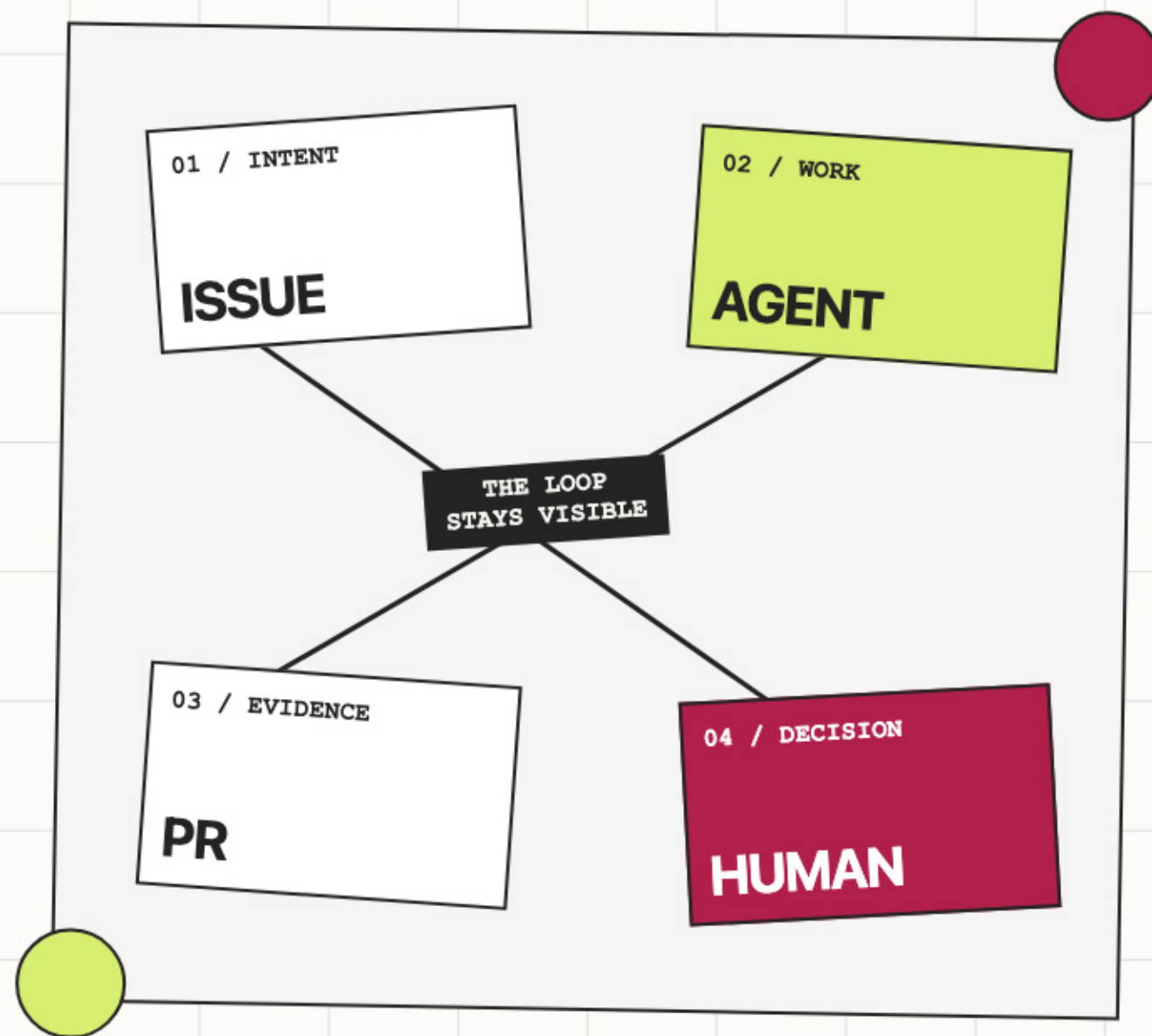
A NEW WAY TO BUILD TOGETHER

The repository is **the room**.

Parallel development with agents needs a shared place to propose work, show evidence, and make decisions.

**Julia Muiruri**

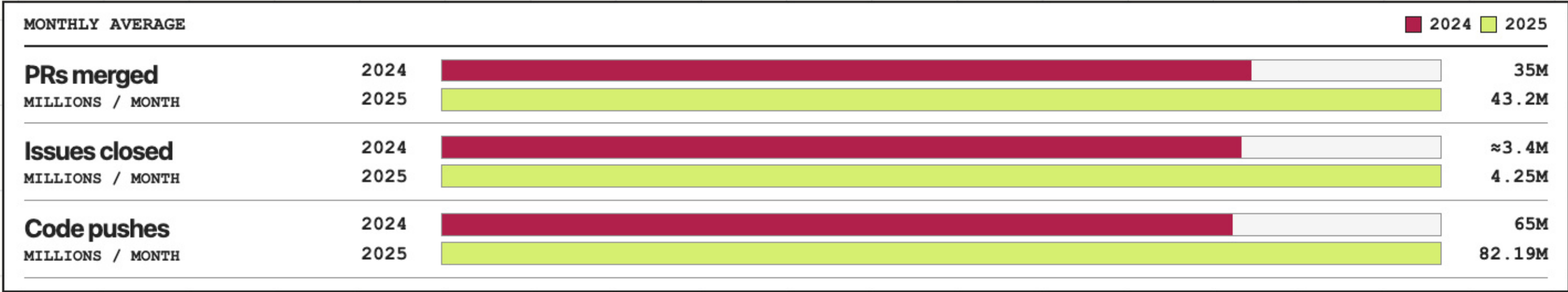
Developer Experiences (DX) at GitHub



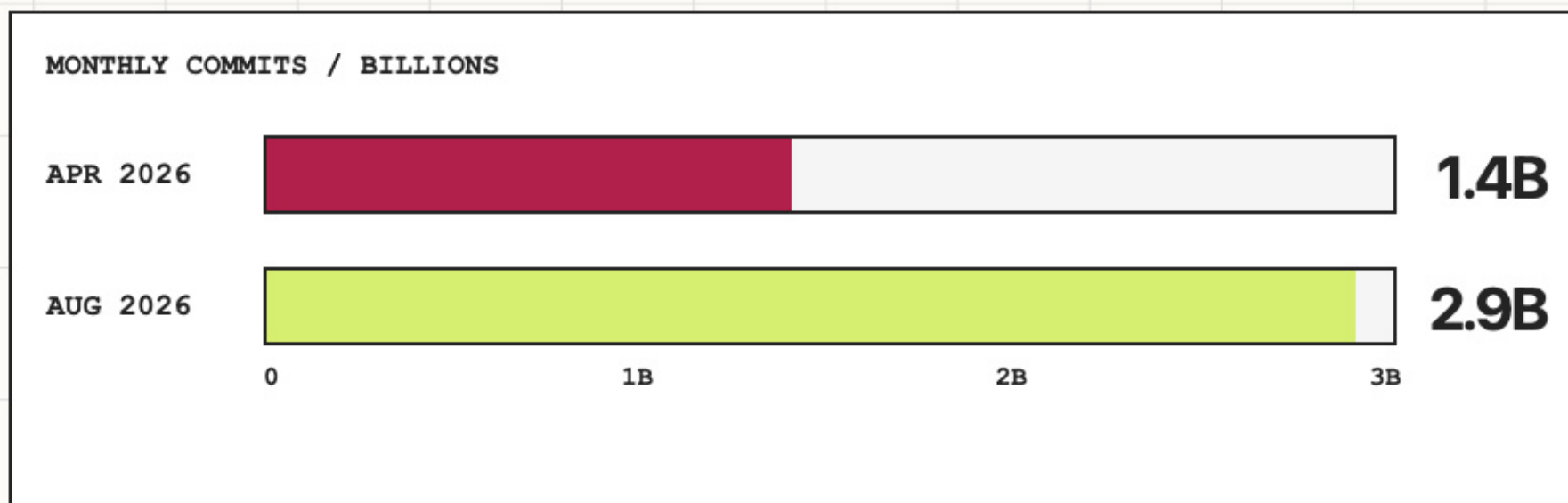
GITHUB OCTOVERSE 2025

More work reaches the review surface.

Across three different measures, the monthly average rose year over year.



The scale of 2026.



AUG 2026

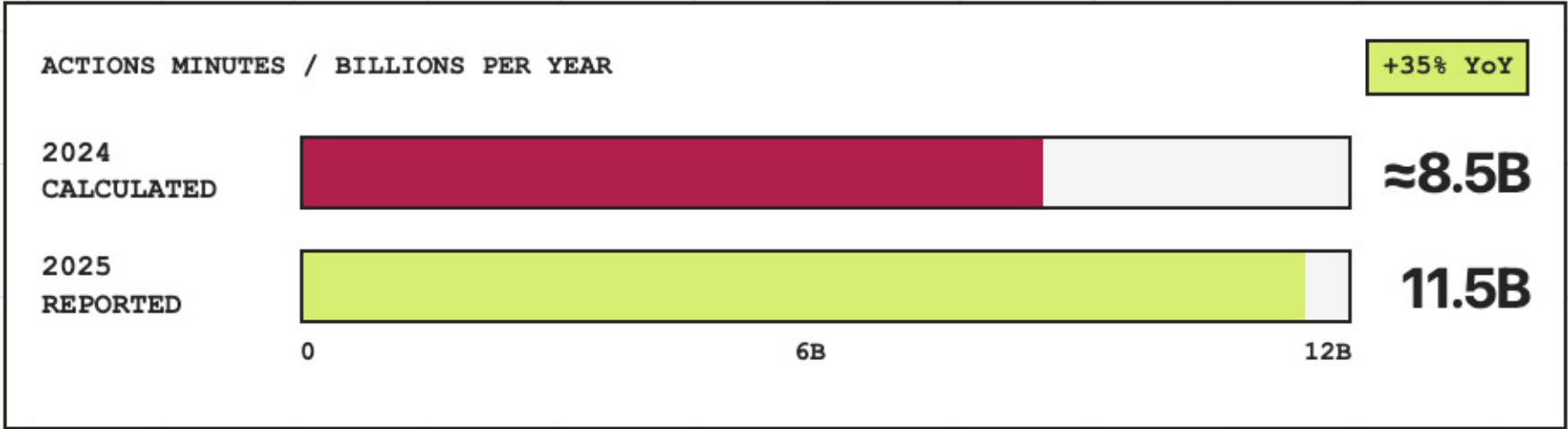
≈130MPRs merged
per month**≈24M**New repositories
per month

The PR and repository estimates are visual readings near the August 2026 endpoints of GitHub's published charts.

GITHUB ACTIONS

Automation has its own scale.

Public and open-source projects used 11.5B Actions minutes in 2025, up 35% from 2024.



PLATFORM-WIDE / DAILY JOBS

71M

jobs per day

Reported in GitHub's Actions update. A daily job count, not the annual public/open-source minutes charted here.

Following the August outage, GitHub pivots its reliability work to focus on adding capacity, improving efficiency, and removing architectural bottlenecks

[SOURCE / GITHUB RELIABILITY UPDATE ↗](#)

BOTH SIDES ARE RIGHT

Two needs. One platform.



DEVELOPERS WANT

More leverage

Agents that can investigate, make a start, and carry work across tools.

LESS FRICTION / MORE CAPABILITY

AND



MAINTAINERS NEED

More control

Clear boundaries for intake, automation, review, and the final call.

CLEARER SIGNAL / ACCOUNTABLE DECISIONS

Speed is not the goal.

Trustworthy flow is.

Make the path from intent to decision legible to everyone in it.



Dimensions of parallelization

Decide where work runs, when it starts, and who remains accountable.

01 / WHERE

Environment

Keep close work local; give independent changes their own workspace.

02 / WHEN

Timing

Work now, on a defined event, or on a deliberate schedule.

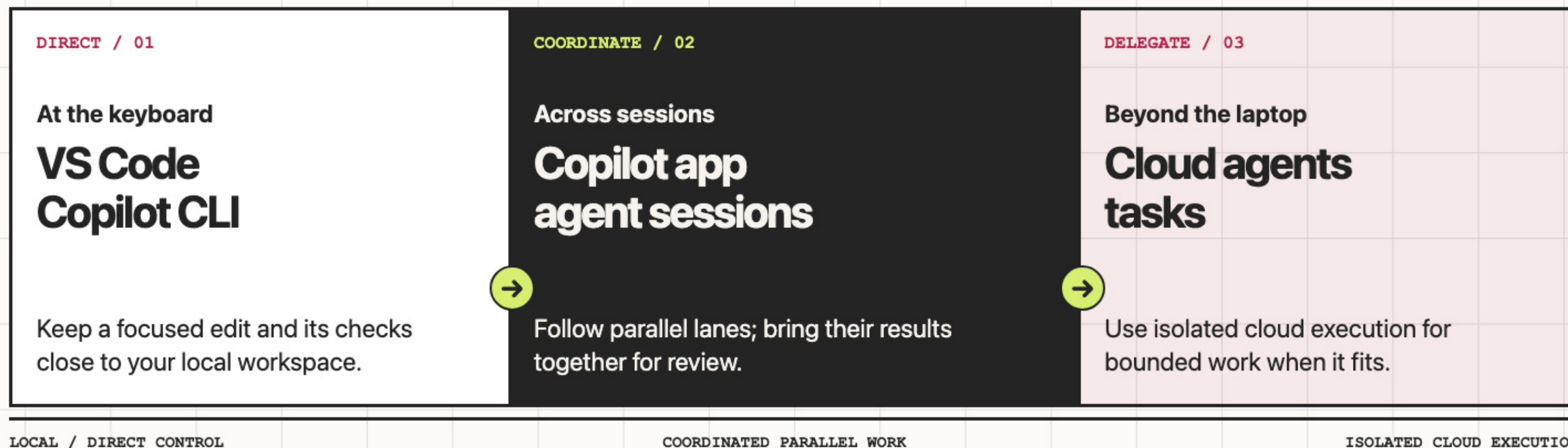
03 / WHO

Ownership

Developer, agent, or focused subagents; a person owns the decision.

Choose the surface for the work.

Match the task to the right degree of direct control, coordination, and isolation.



IDEs: VS Code

Start with project context. Inspect the agent's work before it becomes yours.

01 / TASK CONTEXT

Set the boundary.

Give the goal, repository guidance, and a checkable finish line.

HUMAN INPUT

02 / AGENT EDITS

VS CODE WORKSPACE

TARGET FILE
setup.md

PROPOSAL
A focused change

Stay in the editor while the agent explores and proposes edits.

03 / EVIDENCE

Read the result.

- unclear step

+ checkable step

Diff + test outcome; note what remains uncertain.

04 / HUMAN REVIEW

Keep, revise, or reject.

THE DECISION STAYS WITH YOU

GitHub Copilot CLI

Direct a bounded task at the terminal, then check what actually changed.

TERMINAL / LOCAL WORKSPACE

HUMAN + AGENT

01 / INSPECT

Find the context.

Read the files and repository instructions.

02 / DIRECT

Name one change.

Set scope and a checkable result.

03 / VERIFY

Check the work.

Run focused commands or tests; inspect the diff.

EVIDENCE TO CARRY FORWARD

What can you show?

CHANGESFiles and diff

CHECKSCommands and outcomes

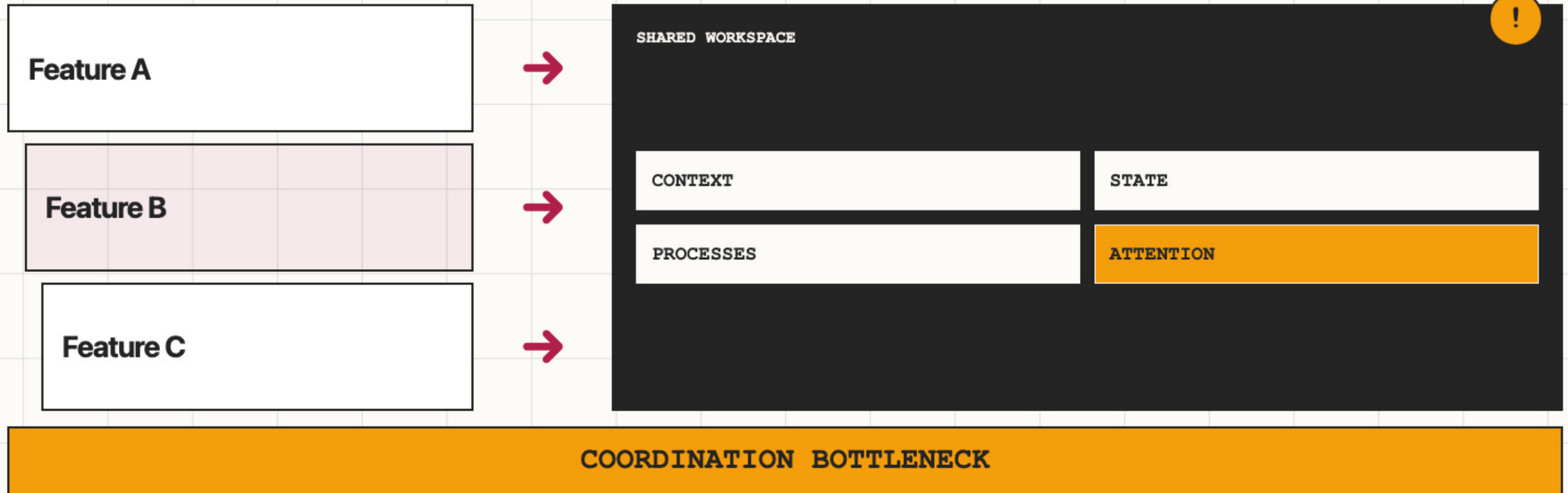
GAPSWhat remains uncertain

04 / HUMAN REVIEW

Make the call.

Keep or revise after reading the evidence.

Parallel work needs coordination.



GITHUB COPILOT APP

Agent-native developer tools

Coordinate parallel agent work. See where attention is needed; keep the review and decision with a person.

gh.io/app

PARALLEL WORK / SHARED VIEW

Feature A

Add search functionality

Feature B

Migrate the database to PostgreSQL

Feature C

Fix checkout validation



HUMAN REVIEW

Decide what moves forward.

A SHARED CONTRACT

Give the work a visible path.

Parallel lanes meet again when issues frame the work and PRs carry its evidence.

01 / FRAME

Issue

What needs to change and why?

HUMAN-DEFINED INTENT

02 / EXPLORE

Agent

What approach might work?

BOUNDED EXECUTION

03 / SHOW

Pull request

What changed, and what supports it?

REVIEWABLE EVIDENCE

04 / GOVERN

Maintainer

Is this ready to merge?

HUMAN DECISION

The agent contributes to the process. It does not replace the process.

PULL REQUESTS

Put the handoff in the PR.

The PR is where generated work becomes reviewable work.

PROPOSED CHANGE

READY FOR REVIEW

Make first-run setup reproducible

- Unclear prerequisite

+ Explicit environment check

+ Verified preview step

AUTHOR: AGENT-ASSISTED

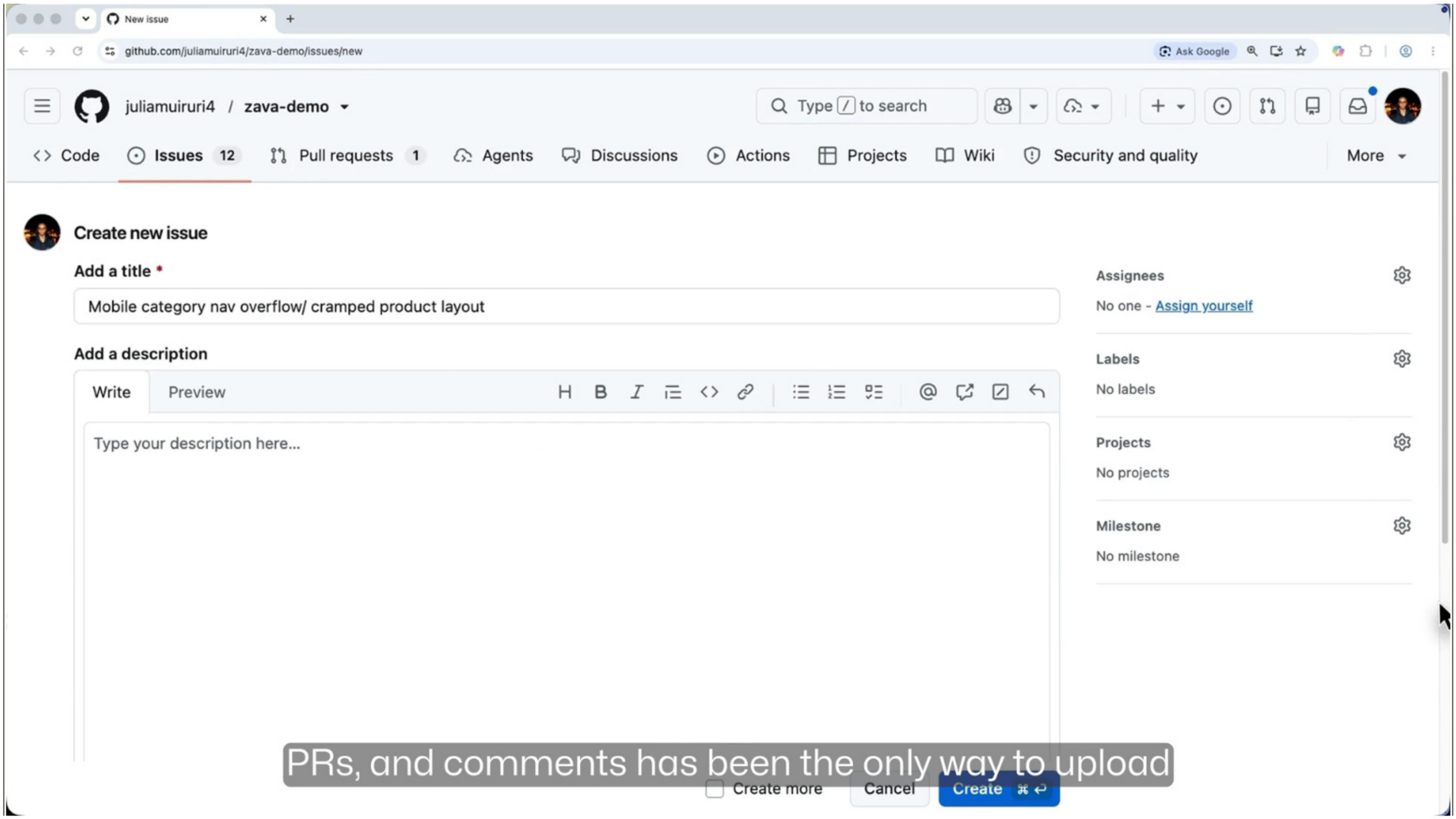
DECISION: MAINTAINER

- 01

Scope
Does the change match the issue?
- 02

Evidence
Do the checks support the claim?
- 03

Judgment
Are the tradeoffs acceptable?



PRs, and comments has been the only way to upload

Ground chat assistant in catalog data #2

<>

Submit review

Open

juliamuiruri4

main

←

juliamuiruri4-ground-chat-in-catalog

+1,313 -159



Turn conversations into code with
GitHub Copilot in Microsoft Teams

A report enters triage.



plan-track-devrel-collab

19 🔊 ⌵ 🔔 🔍 ⋮



Messages



Add canvas



Files & links



Tuesday, September 22nd ▾



juliamuiruri4 3:31 PM

Hey team, I hit a duplicate-close issue while recording the agent automation controls demo.

I'm using `gh-aw v0.88.8` with `close-issue`, `state-reason: duplicate`, and `issue-intent: true`. After switching from **Cautious** to **Full control**, the duplicate still closed automatically instead of waiting for review. 🤔

The intent request failed with HTTP 422: `duplicate_issue_id is required when suggesting a close as duplicate`, gh-aw then logged "falling back to legacy close path" and closed the issue without native intent metadata. The workflow still finished green. I'm assuming this path should fail rather than fall back to an unreviewed closure?

aw handler: github.com/github/gh-aw/blob/.../close_issue.cjs#...

I can share the logs if helpful



1

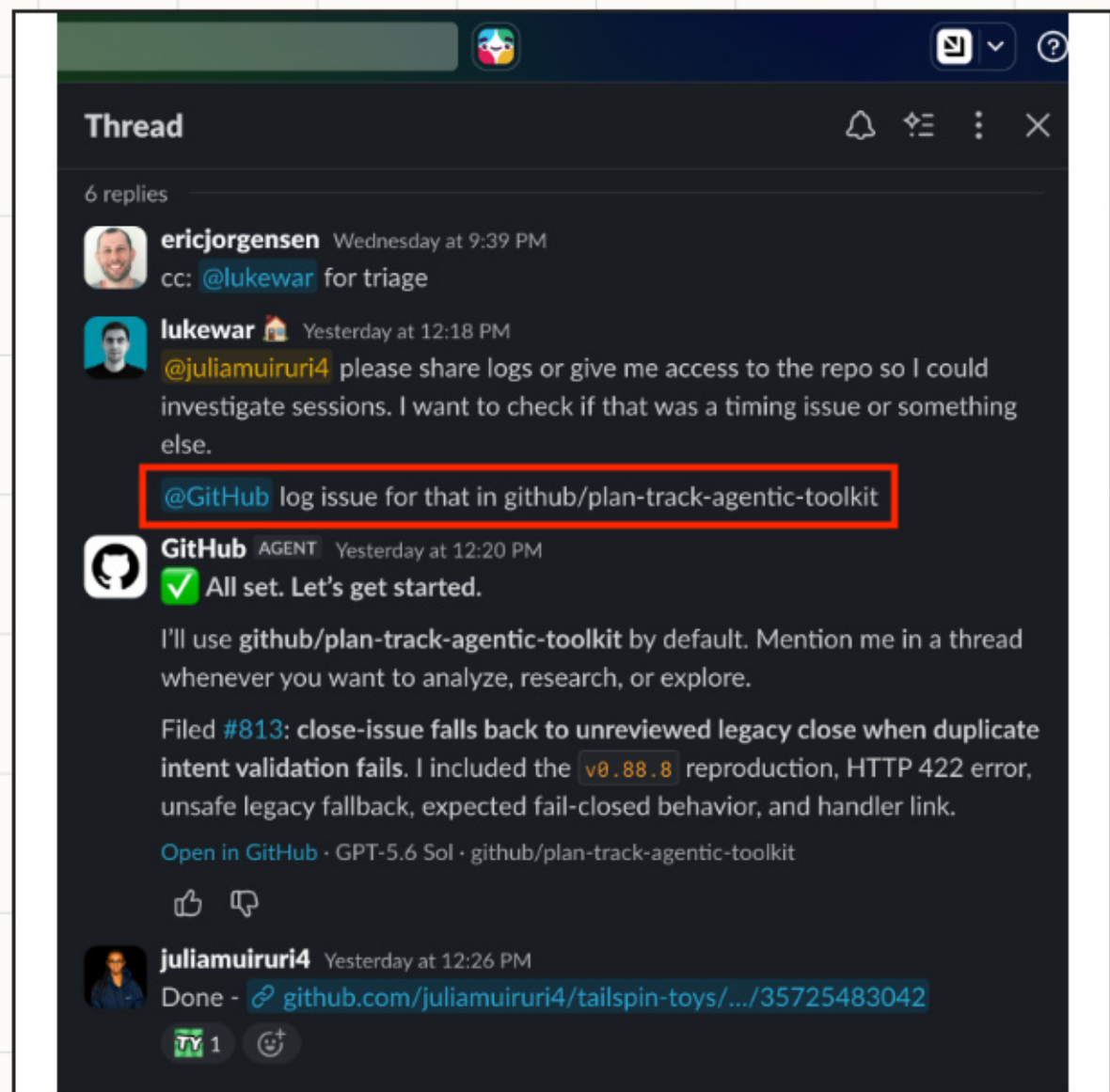


6 replies

Last reply 20 hours ago

The report gets a record.

Issue details on GitHub. Confirmation back in Slack.



Thread

6 replies

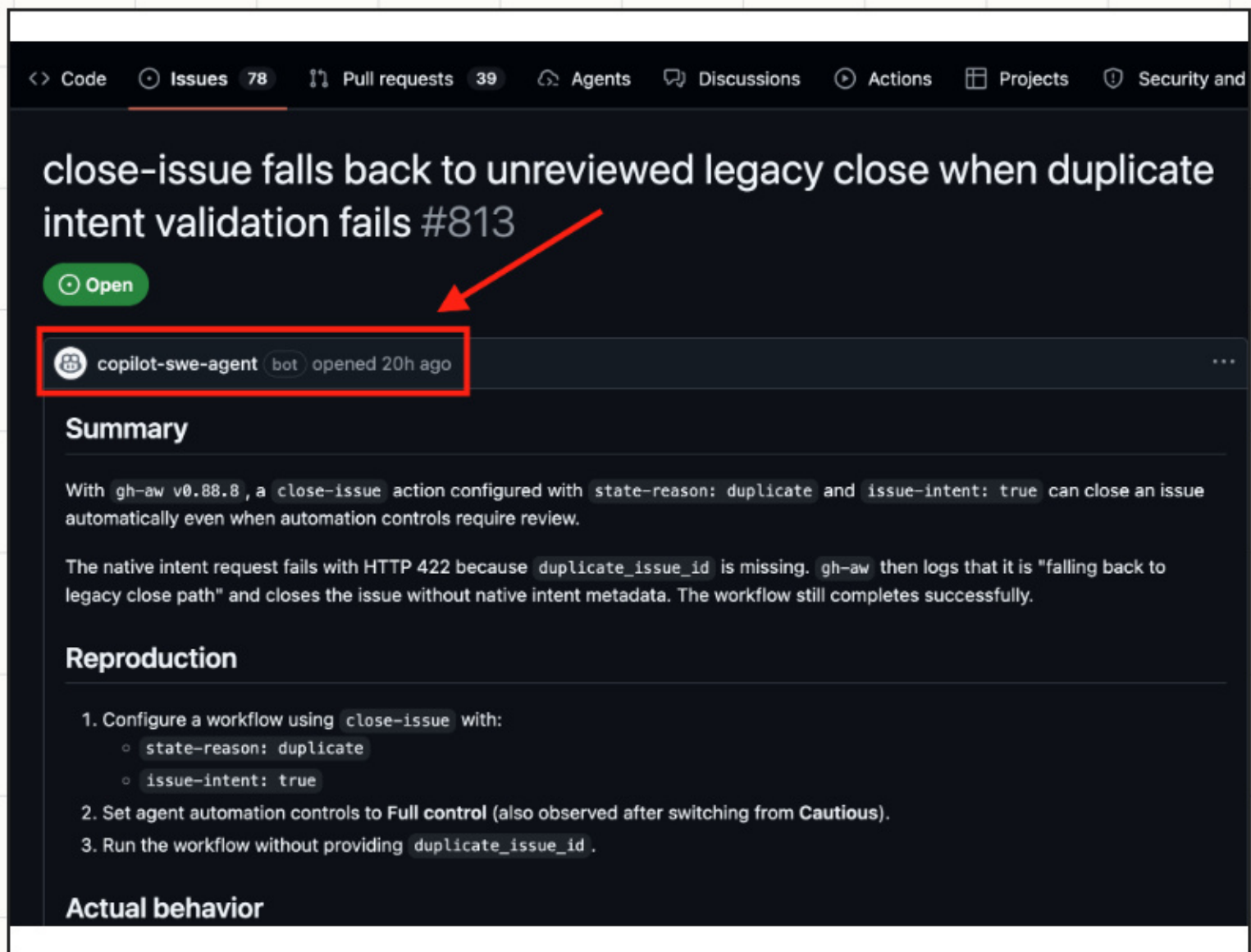
ericjorgensen Wednesday at 9:39 PM
cc: @lukewar for triage

lukewar Yesterday at 12:18 PM
@juliamuiruri4 please share logs or give me access to the repo so I could investigate sessions. I want to check if that was a timing issue or something else.

@GitHub log issue for that in github/plan-track-agentic-toolkit

GitHub AGENT Yesterday at 12:20 PM
✓ All set. Let's get started.
I'll use github/plan-track-agentic-toolkit by default. Mention me in a thread whenever you want to analyze, research, or explore.
Filed #813: close-issue falls back to unreviewed legacy close when duplicate intent validation fails. I included the v0.88.8 reproduction, HTTP 422 error, unsafe legacy fallback, expected fail-closed behavior, and handler link.
Open in GitHub · GPT-5.6 Sol · github/plan-track-agentic-toolkit

juliamuiruri4 Yesterday at 12:26 PM
Done - github.com/juliamuiruri4/tailspin-toys/.../35725483042



<> Code Issues 78 Pull requests 39 Agents Discussions Actions Projects Security and

close-issue falls back to unreviewed legacy close when duplicate intent validation fails #813

Open

copilot-swe-agent bot opened 20h ago

Summary

With gh-aw v0.88.8, a close-issue action configured with state-reason: duplicate and issue-intent: true can close an issue automatically even when automation controls require review.

The native intent request fails with HTTP 422 because duplicate_issue_id is missing. gh-aw then logs that it is "falling back to legacy close path" and closes the issue without native intent metadata. The workflow still completes successfully.

Reproduction

1. Configure a workflow using close-issue with:
 - state-reason: duplicate
 - issue-intent: true
2. Set agent automation controls to Full control (also observed after switching from Cautious).
3. Run the workflow without providing duplicate_issue_id.

Actual behavior

THE HUMAN + AGENT FUTURE

Build the loop you can trust.

People set intent. Agents work in isolated lanes.
Maintainers decide with evidence.

Julia Muiruri

Developer Experiences (DX) at GitHub

 X @juliamuiruri4 GitHub juliamuiruri4 LinkedIn juliamuiruri YouTube @juliamuiruri